Code of Conduct

Meridian Holt Group — People Operations & Legal

Effective March 1, 2026 · Version 6.0

Code of Conduct

1. Introduction and Purpose

Every person who joins Meridian Holt Group — as an employee, contractor, intern, or board member — agrees, as a condition of that relationship, to act consistently with the standards described in this Code of Conduct. This document is not an exhaustive list of every possible situation an employee might face; it is a description of the principles the Company expects people to apply, backed up by specific rules in the areas where specificity matters most: harassment and discrimination, conflicts of interest, confidential information, gifts and entertainment, use of Company systems, and reporting obligations.

This Code applies at all times an employee is representing the Company — in the office, while working remotely, at Company-sponsored events, at industry conferences attended on the Company's behalf, and, in the case of online conduct, whenever the employee is identifiable as a Meridian Holt Group employee, including on personal social media accounts that reference the Company.

Violations of this Code, once substantiated through the Company's standard investigation process, can result in consequences ranging from a documented coaching conversation to immediate termination, depending on severity, and in some cases can result in referral to law enforcement or civil liability for the individual involved. The Company does not apply a rigid one-size-fits-all consequence matrix; outcomes reflect the specific facts, the severity of the conduct, whether it was a first occurrence, and whether the person involved was forthcoming during the investigation.

2. Respect in the Workplace

2.1 Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination

Meridian Holt Group prohibits harassment and discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy, sexual orientation, and gender identity), national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law, in every jurisdiction where the Company operates. This prohibition covers hiring, promotion, compensation, termination, and every other term and condition of employment, as well as day-to-day interactions between colleagues.

Harassment includes, but is not limited to: unwelcome sexual advances or requests for sexual favors; offensive jokes or comments about a protected characteristic; displaying or sharing offensive images or materials, including over Company messaging tools; and creating a hostile work environment through repeated unwelcome conduct, even where no single incident would independently rise to the level of a violation. A single severe incident, such as a physical threat or an unwanted physical touch of a sexual nature, can constitute harassment on its own and does not require a pattern.

Employees who experience or witness conduct that may violate this section should report it

through any of the channels described in Section 9. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith, or who participates in an investigation, is itself a serious violation of this Code, independent of the outcome of the underlying investigation. “Good faith” does not require that the report ultimately be substantiated — it means the person reasonably believed the conduct occurred and was not reporting knowingly false information to harm a colleague.

2.2 Workplace Violence and Threats

The Company has zero tolerance for threats of violence, actual violence, or possession of weapons on Company premises or at Company events, except where an employee’s job specifically and lawfully requires carrying a weapon (which does not apply to any role at Meridian Holt Group as of this policy’s effective date). Any employee who feels physically unsafe should contact Physical Security or, if there is an immediate threat, local emergency services first and Physical Security second.

2.3 Substance Use

Employees may not be under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs while performing work duties, operating Company equipment, or representing the Company at client-facing events, except for moderate alcohol consumption at Company-sanctioned social events where alcohol is served, which remains subject to the general expectation of professional conduct. Impairment on the job is treated as a safety and performance issue and is handled through the same investigation and consequence process as other Code violations.

3. Conflicts of Interest

A conflict of interest arises whenever an employee’s personal interests — financial, familial, or otherwise — could reasonably be seen to influence, or actually influence, decisions they make on behalf of the Company. Conflicts of interest are not automatically prohibited; many are manageable once disclosed. What is prohibited is failing to disclose one.

Common conflict scenarios that must be disclosed to a manager and to People Operations include: supervising, hiring, or setting the compensation of a family member or someone with whom the employee has a close personal relationship; holding a significant financial interest (generally, more than a token amount, and always more than 1% ownership) in a Company vendor, customer, or competitor; serving on the board of, or doing paid consulting work for, an organization that does business with the Company; and directing Company business to a vendor owned or run by a friend or family member without going through the normal vendor evaluation process.

Employees are required to complete an annual Conflict of Interest disclosure and must also disclose new conflicts as they arise, rather than waiting for the annual cycle. Failure to disclose a known conflict is treated more seriously than the underlying conflict itself, because it removes the Company’s ability to manage the situation appropriately.

4. Confidential Information and Intellectual Property

4.1 What Counts as Confidential

Confidential information includes, without limitation: unreleased product plans and roadmaps; source code and technical designs; customer and prospect lists and any information about specific customers’ usage or contracts; financial results before public release; compensation and personnel information about other employees; and the existence and terms of unannounced partnerships, acquisitions, or fundraising activity. Employees are expected to treat information as confidential by default unless they know it has already been made public by an authorized Company communication.

4.2 Handling Confidential Information

Confidential information should only be shared with other employees who have a legitimate business need to know it, and should never be discussed in public places, on personal social media, on personal devices not enrolled in the Company's device management system, or with friends and family, even under an assumption of trust. This obligation continues after an employee's employment ends; it does not expire at termination or resignation.

Employees who are contacted by press, investors, or analysts asking about Company plans, financial performance, or any non-public matter should decline to comment and refer the inquiry to the Communications team; no employee is authorized to speak to press on the Company's behalf unless specifically designated to do so for that purpose.

4.3 Intellectual Property

Work product created by employees within the scope of their employment, using Company resources, or relating to the Company's actual or anticipated business, belongs to the Company, consistent with the Proprietary Information and Inventions Agreement each employee signs at hire. Employees who believe a specific project falls outside this scope — for example, a personal side project unrelated to the Company's business, built entirely on personal time and equipment — should raise it proactively with Legal rather than assuming it is exempt.

5. Use of Company Systems and Assets

Company laptops, accounts, and communication tools are provided for business purposes. Limited, reasonable personal use (checking personal email, browsing during a break) is permitted and is not itself a violation, but employees should have no expectation of privacy in anything sent, received, stored, or accessed on Company systems. The Company reserves the right to monitor, access, and review Company systems and accounts as needed for security, legal, or business reasons, subject to applicable law in the relevant jurisdiction.

Employees may not use Company systems to access, store, or distribute illegal content; to run a personal business unrelated to the Company; to install unauthorized software that has not been approved by IT Security; or to circumvent security controls, including disabling endpoint protection or using unapproved cloud storage for Company data.

6. Gifts, Entertainment, and Anti-Bribery

Employees may accept or offer modest, customary business gifts and entertainment (for example, a reasonably priced meal with a vendor) as part of normal business relationship-building. Employees may not accept or offer cash or cash-equivalent gifts (including gift cards above a nominal value) under any circumstances, and may not accept or offer any gift, payment, or benefit intended to improperly influence a business decision, whether directed at a Company employee or at an employee of a customer, vendor, or government official.

Interactions with government officials carry additional risk under anti-corruption laws such as the U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act and equivalent laws in other jurisdictions where the Company operates, and require advance consultation with Legal before any gift, meal, or entertainment is offered, regardless of value.

7. Fair Dealing and Competition

Employees are expected to deal fairly with the Company's customers, suppliers, competitors, and each other, and may not take unfair advantage of anyone through manipulation, concealment, abuse of privileged information, misrepresentation of material facts, or any other unfair practice.

Employees who gain access to a competitor’s confidential information — for example, because they previously worked there — must not use or disclose it at Meridian Holt Group; doing so exposes both the individual and the Company to legal liability.

8. Accurate Records and Financial Integrity

All Company records — expense reports, timesheets, sales forecasts, financial statements, and any documentation submitted to auditors, regulators, or the board — must be accurate and complete. Employees may never falsify a record, backdate a document, or knowingly permit a colleague to do so. This obligation applies regardless of whether the inaccuracy seems minor or whether the employee believes the end result serves a legitimate business goal; the integrity of Company records is not something individual employees are authorized to weigh against other priorities.

9. Reporting Concerns

Employees who witness or suspect a violation of this Code — including, but not limited to, harassment, discrimination, retaliation, fraud, safety issues, or misuse of Company assets — are expected to report it. Reports can be made to: a manager; any HRBP; the People Operations leadership team directly; Legal; or the confidential Ethics Hotline, which is operated by an independent third party, accepts anonymous reports, and is available by phone or web form 24 hours a day, seven days a week, in every language spoken by a meaningful portion of the Company’s workforce.

Reports made in good faith are protected from retaliation as described in Section 2.1, and this protection applies regardless of which reporting channel the employee uses. The Company investigates all reports, using trained investigators from People Operations or Legal, and keeps information confidential to the extent possible while still allowing for a thorough and fair investigation, which sometimes requires disclosing limited information to the people directly involved.

10. Consequences and Appeals

Substantiated violations of this Code result in consequences determined case by case, which may include coaching, a formal written warning, a Performance Improvement Plan, demotion, suspension, or termination, and in cases involving illegal conduct, referral to law enforcement. An employee who disagrees with the outcome of an investigation may request a review by a People Operations leader who was not involved in the original investigation; this review is limited to whether the investigation process was followed correctly and whether the conclusion was reasonably supported by the evidence gathered.

11. Acknowledgment

All employees are required to acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Code of Conduct at the time of hire and annually thereafter, through the HR portal. Failure to complete the acknowledgment does not exempt an employee from the obligations described in this document; the Code applies to all employees regardless of acknowledgment status.

12. Social Media and External Communications

Employees are free to maintain personal social media accounts and to discuss their work in general terms, and the Company encourages authentic employee voices as part of its culture. That

said, a few specific rules apply once an employee's connection to the Company is identifiable, whether through a bio, a post's content, or general public knowledge:

Employees may not disclose confidential information (as defined in Section 4.1) on any personal or public platform, regardless of privacy settings, since screenshots and re-shares can defeat any privacy control after the fact. Employees may not speak on the Company's behalf, or in a way that could reasonably be read as an official Company position, unless specifically authorized to do so by Communications or Legal. Employees are encouraged, when discussing their work publicly, to include a brief disclaimer that views expressed are their own, though the Company recognizes this disclaimer does not eliminate all risk and is not itself a defense against violations of other parts of this Code.

Disagreements with Company decisions, when expressed publicly in a way that discloses confidential internal deliberations or misrepresents Company positions, can constitute a Code violation independent of whether the employee's underlying opinion is reasonable; employees are always free to disagree internally, through the channels described in Section 9, without that disagreement itself being a problem.

13. Data Privacy and Handling of Personal Information

Employees who handle personal information belonging to customers, prospects, job applicants, or fellow employees — including names, contact details, payment information, or any other data that could identify a specific individual — must handle it consistently with the Company's Data Privacy Policy and with applicable law in the relevant jurisdiction, which for the Company's global customer base can include the EU General Data Protection Regulation, the California Consumer Privacy Act, and other regional privacy frameworks.

Practically, this means: personal information should only be accessed by employees who have a legitimate business need; it should never be exported to a personal device or personal cloud storage account; it should never be used for a purpose other than the one it was originally collected for without going through the process described in the Data Privacy Policy; and any suspected data breach, however small, must be reported to Security immediately rather than being investigated informally first, since regulatory reporting deadlines in many jurisdictions begin running from the moment of discovery, not the moment an internal investigation concludes.

Employees who are unsure whether a specific use of personal data is permitted should default to asking the Data Privacy team before proceeding, rather than proceeding and asking forgiveness afterward; this is one of the few areas of this Code where the cost of an unauthorized action can be very high (regulatory fines, breach notification obligations, reputational harm) relative to the cost of a short delay to ask first.

14. Health, Safety, and Environment

The Company is committed to providing a safe working environment in every office location, consistent with applicable occupational health and safety law. Employees are expected to follow posted safety procedures, report hazards or near-misses to Facilities or Physical Security promptly, and participate in required safety training (such as fire evacuation drills) when scheduled. Employees who believe a safety concern is not being adequately addressed may escalate beyond their immediate manager to Facilities leadership or to People Operations without fear of retaliation, consistent with the general anti-retaliation protection described in Section 2.1.

For roles involving Company-provided vehicles, hardware lab equipment, or other specialized equipment with its own safety procedures, additional role-specific safety training is required before an employee may operate that equipment, and is tracked separately from general Code of Conduct training.

15. Political Activity and Company Resources

Employees are free to engage in political activity, including making personal political donations and expressing personal political views outside of work, on their own time. Company resources — including Company email, Company equipment, Company funds, and work time — may not be used for personal political activity, including personal campaign volunteering, fundraising for a candidate or cause, or organizing political events, regardless of the employee's personal views on the underlying issue. The Company may, from time to time, take institutional positions on matters that directly affect its business (such as legislation specifically regulating the Company's industry); such institutional positions are decided by executive leadership and Communications, not by individual employees speaking on the Company's behalf.

16. Outside Employment and Moonlighting

Employees may hold outside employment or engage in freelance work outside of Company time, provided it does not create a conflict of interest under Section 3, does not compete with the Company's business, does not use Company confidential information or resources, and does not interfere with the employee's ability to perform their Company role at the expected standard. Employees considering outside employment, particularly anything in the same industry as the Company's business, should disclose it to their manager and People Operations before beginning, so that any conflict can be identified and addressed early rather than after the fact.

Full-time exempt employees should also be mindful that outside work, even where it does not create a formal conflict of interest, can raise legitimate performance concerns if it results in reduced availability, missed deadlines, or diminished work quality; outside employment is not a defense against ordinary performance management in such cases.

17. Environmental and Community Responsibility

The Company expects employees to act consistently with its published environmental and community commitments when representing the Company, including in vendor selection (preferring, where reasonably comparable in cost and quality, vendors with credible sustainability practices) and in day-to-day office operations (following office recycling and waste-reduction programs where available). This section reflects Company values rather than a strict compliance obligation with specific enforcement consequences, but repeated, willful disregard for these commitments in a way that embarrasses or exposes the Company to reputational risk can be addressed under the general conduct standards in this Code.

18. Training and Recertification

Beyond the annual acknowledgment described in Section 11, employees in specific roles are required to complete additional targeted training on a recurring basis: employees with people-management responsibilities complete anti-harassment and inclusive-management training annually; employees with access to customer financial data complete data security training annually; and employees involved in vendor selection or government-facing sales complete anti-bribery training annually. People Operations tracks completion centrally and follows up directly with employees and their managers when required training falls overdue.

19. Illustrative Scenarios

These scenarios are provided as examples of how this Code applies in practice. They are not exhaustive, and a real situation that differs from the facts below is still governed by the general principles in Sections 1 through 18, not by whichever example seems closest.

Scenario A — A vendor offers event tickets. A vendor the Company works with offers an employee two tickets to a sporting event, worth approximately $150 each, with no specific ask attached. Under Section 6, this falls into the category of gifts requiring judgment: it exceeds "nominal," so the employee should disclose the offer to their manager before accepting, and in most cases a single instance of moderate-value entertainment tied to an existing legitimate business relationship, with no decision pending, would be approved. The analysis would be different if the employee were currently evaluating that vendor in an active procurement decision, in which case the offer should be declined.

Scenario B — An employee's sibling applies for an open role on their team. An employee's sibling applies for a role that would report to the employee. This is a conflict of interest under Section 3 regardless of the sibling's qualifications. The employee must disclose the relationship to their manager and People Operations before participating in any part of the hiring process for that role, and in practice will typically be recused from the interview loop and hiring decision entirely, with another member of the team or a skip-level manager handling it instead.

Scenario C — A colleague asks a coworker to falsify a timesheet "just this once." An hourly employee asks a colleague who approves timesheets to record a few hours they didn't actually work, framing it as a one-time favor to cover a personal emergency. Section 8 does not carve out exceptions for sympathetic circumstances; falsifying a record is a violation regardless of motive, and the person being asked to approve it should decline and, if they're concerned about retaliation for declining, may report the request through any channel in Section 9.

Scenario D — An employee overhears a joke they find offensive but that seems to be "just banter" among the people involved. Section 2.1 protects against a hostile work environment based on repeated or severe unwelcome conduct; whether specific banter crosses that line often depends on facts the observer may not have, such as whether the participants have an established rapport and whether it is genuinely welcome by everyone involved, including anyone who overhears it but isn't part of the original exchange. Employees who are uncomfortable, whether or not they were the intended audience, are encouraged to report it; the investigation process exists precisely to sort out these fact-specific situations rather than expecting individual employees to make that judgment call alone.

Scenario E — An employee is asked by a manager to backdate an approval to make a deal appear to have closed before quarter-end. This is a clear violation of Section 8's accurate-records requirement, and the fact that the request comes from a manager does not change that; being instructed by a superior to falsify a record is not a defense, and the Company's investigation and consequence process treats pressuring a subordinate to falsify records as an aggravating factor for the person applying the pressure, not a mitigating factor for the person who complies. Employees in this situation should report it through the Ethics Hotline if they are uncomfortable reporting to their own chain of command.

20. Version History and Governance

This Code of Conduct is owned jointly by People Operations and Legal and is formally reviewed at least annually, with interim updates made as needed to reflect changes in law, regulation, or Company structure (such as expansion into a new country with different legal requirements). Material changes are announced to all employees by email and require a fresh acknowledgment through the HR portal; minor clarifying edits that do not change substantive obligations may be made without a company-wide announcement but are always reflected in the version number and effective date shown at the top of this document, which employees should check if they are relying on a downloaded or printed copy rather than the current version in the HR portal.